

Zaid Daghash

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Computer Systems Engineering graduate with First Class Honours (GPA: 4.0) from The University of Sheffield and a current MSc Cyber Security student at Liverpool John Moores University. Experienced in project leadership, cross-functional collaboration, and delivering innovative engineering and software solutions under tight deadlines. Open to opportunities across all sectors to apply technical and problem-solving expertise while contributing to organizational success.

COMPETITIONS

Capture The Flag (CTF) – National Cyber Security Agency (NCSA)

2025

Rosewood Doha Hotel | Qatar

KEY PROJECTS

Security Automation Tool

- Developed a Python SOAR utility to enrich IOC indicators via public APIs and generate triage reports.
- Automated noisy alert filtering and produced CSV/JSON summaries to speed SOC investigation workflows.

Burglar Alarm System with Facial Recognition

- Directed a team of 4 students through a full project cycle, managing technical deliverables and timelines.
- Implemented a burglar alarm system using low embedded devices, programmed the functionality using C, and integrated facial recognition using MATLAB.

File Encryption & Security Tool

- Developed a Java-based GUI application that enables users to scan directories, view file metadata, and perform AES-256 encryption and decryption on files and folders.
- Implemented secure folder encryption with user-defined passwords and file integrity verification using SHA-256 hashing, with all actions logged automatically to a text file.
- Designed an intuitive interface using Java Swing, allowing for seamless navigation, real-time system feedback, and atomic file operations to prevent data exposure during encryption.

Offensive & Defensive Security Engineer Simulation: Penetration Testing and IDS Deployment

- Executed 5 distinct attacks (SSH brute-force, RCE on Drupal/LotusCMS, kernel privilege escalation, and Tomcat WAR deployment) against a target server using Kali Linux and Metasploit.
- Analyzed network traffic in Wireshark to extract attack signatures and created 5 custom Suricata rules to detect them. Identified a post-exploitation attack that cannot be detected by a network-based IDS, justifying the need for HIDS/EDR solutions.
- Configured Splunk to ingest server logs (auth.log, access.log) and formulated precise queries to pinpoint attack patterns (e.g., brute-force traffic, malicious web requests), effectively hunting for adversarial activity.

Reinforcement Learning Project

- Implemented and compared Q-learning and SARSA algorithms to train an autonomous agent in different grid environments with deterministic, stochastic, and multi-target reward systems.
- Designed and tuned hyperparameters (learning rate, discount factor, exploration rate) to analyze algorithm performance across 5000+ episodes.
- Demonstrated the trade-offs between on-policy and off-policy learning, achieving optimized navigation strategies and improved convergence using policies such as epsilon-greedy and SoftMax.

EDUCATION

Master of Science (MSc), Cyber Security

2025 - 2026

Liverpool John Moores University – Oryx University | Qatar

- **Relevant modules include:** Computer Security, Network Security, Information Security Management, Ethical Hacking, Secure Systems

Bachelor of Engineering (BEng), Computer Systems Engineering

2021 - 2024

The University of Sheffield | United Kingdom | First Class Honours (GPA: 4.0)

- **Relevant modules include:** Introduction to Electric & Electronic Circuits, Digital Signal Processing, Mechatronics, Introduction to Systems Engineering & Software, Systems Engineering and Object-Oriented Programming, Computer Problem Solving and Object-Oriented Design, Systems Design and Security, Machine Learning, Computer Security and Forensics, Reinforcement Learning.

SKILLS

- **Cybersecurity Tools:** Wireshark, Nmap, Metasploit, Nessus, Splunk
- **OS:** Windows, Linux
- **Programming Languages:** Python, Java, C, MATLAB
- **Microsoft Tools:** Word, Excel, PowerPoint
- **Core Skills:** Analytical | Problem-Solving | Project Leadership | Cross-functional Collaboration | Adaptability | Communication
- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Arabic (Native)

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA: [Security+](#), [Network+](#)
- IBM: [Introduction to AI \(Honours\)](#) | [Generative AI: Prompt Engineering Basics](#) | [Generative AI: Introduction and Applications](#) | [Introduction to Software Engineering \(Honours\)](#) | [Introduction to HTML, CSS, & JavaScript](#)
- HackerRank: [Java \(Basic\)](#) | [Python \(Basic\)](#)